

Bachelor's Thesis Proposal

A Taxonomy of Online Scams in Vietnam

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1 Motivation

Online fraud and scams are a growing problem in Vietnam. According to a research report by the Safer Internet Lab, in 2024, online fraud and scams resulted in substantial economic losses, approximately 18,900 billion VND [3].

Typical examples include impersonating banks, utility companies, or the police, as well as fake online jobs and investment schemes on social networks. Several tools have already been developed to help users. For example, the community project *ChongLuaDao* [2] allows users to check whether a given website is malicious. However, these tools target specific types of scams or indicators and assume that the user already has a concrete indicator, such as a URL, a phone number, or a bank account.

Information about scam types exists mostly in the form of scattered news articles. There is no systematic classification of scams in Vietnam that people can consult to recognize the scam they are facing.

2 Objective

The objective of this thesis is to develop a *taxonomy* of online fraud and scams in Vietnam. Starting from real scam cases, the thesis will analyze and categorize them and organize the resulting categories into a hierarchy of scam concepts. Each concept should include at least a short description, examples of typical scripts, warning signs, and recommended actions.

The scams should be structurally classified, e.g., in the spirit of the ACM Computing Classification System [1].

The taxonomy should be stored in a database management system and published as a simple web page so that people can browse the hierarchy to find the scam they are facing, and so that individual scam cases can be tagged with concepts from it.

3 Tasks

1. Review existing anti-scam tools and reports in Vietnam and their classification systems.
2. Create a collection of real scam cases from public sources, such as news articles and official warnings.
3. Read and categorize the cases, and organize the categories into a hierarchical taxonomy with a description for each concept.
4. Design a storage system to hold the classifications, descriptions, and recommendations of the categorized cases.
5. Create a simple web application to publish the taxonomy.
6. Document the methodology, the taxonomy, and its validation in the final report.

4 Deliverables

The following deliverables are due at the end of the project:

Final report Please have a look at the submission requirements in the following section. The final report should consist of an introduction, a (theoretical) background section, sections describing the work packages and their outcomes, and a conclusion. The report must be written in English.

Source code Complete, documented source code.

Presentation At the end of the thesis, a 20-minute presentation must be given in a thesis defense seminar. It should give an overview and discuss the most important highlights of the work.

References

- [1] Association for Computing Machinery. The 2012 ACM computing classification system, 2012. <https://dl.acm.org/ccs>.
- [2] ChongLuaDao. Chong lua dao. <https://chongluadao.vn>.
- [3] Nong Phuong Thao. Online fraud and scams in vietnam. Research report, Safer Internet Lab, 2025. https://saferinternetlab.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/06/Research-Report-A4_Fraud-Vietnam.pdf.